Certificate in Financial Planning: Accounting majors

Advising one-pager · BBA in Accounting, 2026-27 catalog · Gatton College, November 2026

Scan: how to add it

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Investment banking or private equity: Investment Banking. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/roadmaps

What it is

Financial planners help people manage money across investments, taxes, retirement, insurance, and estates. Personal financial advisors earned a **median of $105,070** in 2025, according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics. The six courses satisfy the **education requirement** for CFP® certification; the exam, experience, and ethics requirements complete it. Open to any major, and full-time on-campus undergraduates add it in myGPS at **no additional tuition**. Each course needs a C or better. No business courses are needed first; only FIN 359 must come after the others.

The six courses

Area	Course	Offered	For an Accounting major
Fundamentals	**FIN 350***	Fall, spring	free elective
Tax	**ACC 407** ✓	Fall, spring	fills the ACC 403/407/418 choice
Investment	**FIN 357**	Fall, spring	free elective
Estate	**ACC 457** ✓	Fall, spring	counts as an ACC 400-level course
Retirement	**FIN 358**	Fall, spring; no alternate course	free elective
Capstone	**FIN 359**	Fall, spring; taken last	free elective

* FIN 350 lists a 60-credit-hour prerequisite that can be waived: email the director. ACC 457's tax prerequisite is waived for certificate students.

ACC 356 and ACC 357 do not count toward the Accounting major, and ACC 357 cannot follow ACC 407, so Accounting majors should use FIN 350 and ACC 407.

The posted four-year plan, with the certificate on top

Year	Fall	Spring
Freshman	CIS 110, MA 109, UK Core ×3	CIS 111, MA 123, UK Core ×3
Sophomore	AN 105, ACC 200, ECO 201, STA 296, MKT 300, elective	ECO 202, ACC 201, MGT 301, MA 162, elective
Junior	ACC 301, ACC 424, ECO 391, FIN 300, **FIN 350***	ACC 302, **ACC 407** ✓, AN 300, CIS 300, MGT 340
Senior	**ACC 457** ✓, ACC 400-level, **FIN 357**, **FIN 358**	ACC 475, **FIN 359**, elective ×2

Roadmap course **Counts for roadmap and major** ✓ Major requirement UK Core, electives *Italic = recommended* One term only

The certificate takes **four of the plan's eight electives**; ACC 407 and ACC 457 count toward the major. FIN 357 and FIN 358 fill senior fall's two electives; a missed FIN 350 fits there as a fifth course.

Three things to know

1. **It counts twice.** ACC 407 fills the major's tax choice and ACC 457 counts as an ACC 400-level course, so the whole certificate costs four electives.
2. **No course is limited to one term.** All six run fall and spring. Save FIN 359, the capstone, for last.
3. **It fits the CPA path.** Students on the 150-hour path to the CPA can count the certificate's hours toward it and leave with a second credential.

After the certificate

- Students can sit for the CFP exam as soon as their completion is reported. Experience (6,000 hours, or 4,000 through an apprenticeship) and the bachelor's degree can follow the exam.
- Licenses depend on the job: Series 65 or 66 for RIA roles; SIE, Series 7, and 63 or 66 for broker-dealers; state life and health for insurance. We **recommend the SIE** for every student: it needs no sponsoring firm and is not required for the CFP.
- Get involved: the Finance Society's Financial Planning Pathway.

To add the certificate: talk with an advisor, then myUK → myGPS → My Program of Study → Request a Major Change → Add a Major, and search for Financial Planning (adds the certificate, not a second major). Details: gatton.uky.edu/certificate-financial-planning, or scan the code at top.

Terms. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours. SIE: Securities Industry Essentials, FINRA's entry-level exam. ACC 403/407/418 choice: the major requires one of these three courses. ACC 400-level: the upper-level accounting courses the major requires.

Director: Will Gerken, CFP®, will.gerken@uky.edu · Plan: posted 2026-27 Accounting sample curriculum; the catalog year a student entered under governs.

A general guide, not official advising. Compiled from publicly posted UK catalog and curriculum pages; requirements change and no warranty is given. Confirm your plan with your academic advisor and your myUK GPS degree audit.